

As Figure 10.2 shows, you may still have expenses even after your deductible is met. In this example, in addition to paying the deductible, you need to pay the 20% coinsurance of the remaining \$8,500 balance. With copay and coinsurance, it is usually one or the other; you will not need to pay both a copay and a coinsurance for a single trip to the doctor.

Out-of-pocket maximum. The **out-of-pocket maximum** is the maximum amount of money you'll spend for medical services in a year before your insurance provider steps in to pay 100% of covered costs. Any money you spend on deductibles, copays, and coinsurance counts toward your out-of-pocket maximum. In the \$10,000 surgery example above, you would have paid \$3,200 toward your maximum out-of-pocket costs for the year because you paid \$1,500 for the deductible and \$1,700 for your 20% of the coinsurance. You will, however, need to continue paying your premium even after you have met your out-of-pocket maximum. As long as you have a health insurance plan, you will need to keep paying the premium.

In-network versus out-of-network. Just because you have health insurance does not mean you can go see any doctor you want and still receive the same coverage. Doctors and providers who work within your network will typically be covered much more extensively. An **in-network provider** works with or for the network of your insurance provider; an **out-of-network provider** is not affiliated with your insurance provider. If you are covered by Kaiser Permanente, they prefer you see doctors who work within the Kaiser network; if you are covered by Anthem, they prefer you see doctors who work within the Anthem network, and so on. Before you seek medical services, especially from a specialist you have not visited before, be sure to find out if they are considered in-network or out-of-network by your